

Lesson 106: To Cover or Not to Cover

Do I cover or not?

1



SMALL ON SMALL:

general rule when a low card is led from the dummy.

2



HONOR ON HONOR:

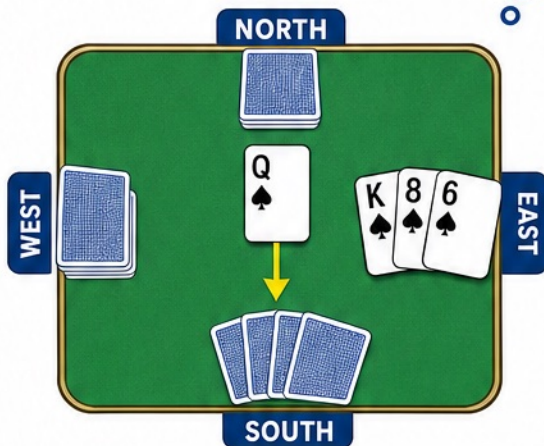
cover only if you hope to **ESTABLISH** a lower card.

3



WITH A SOLID SEQUENCE:

play the highest.
(e.g., QJ10 → play Q)



4



TWO HONORS IN THE DUMMY: DO NOT cover the FIRST, cover the SECOND!

- Example: QJ in the dummy, you have Kxx in East.

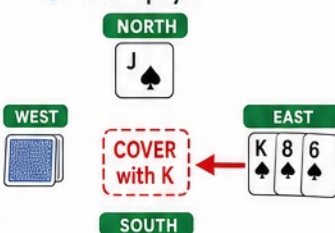
♠ North plays Q → **PASS**
(keep K on J).

♠ If North plays J next →
COVER with K.

1 North plays Q



2 North plays J



Note: if East has AKxxx, never cover:
Ace captures the suit anyway.



5



LENGTH FACTOR:

with long cards under the honor, more reason to cover.



More cards under the King = more reason to cover.



SUMMARY CHART

ALWAYS COVER



- Honor on honor when you need to establish a lower card.
- When you have a very long sequence under the honor.
- When partner has shown shortage in the suit.

NEVER COVER



- Two honors in the dummy – first honor led.
- When you have Ace-K (or Ace alone).
- When covering achieves nothing (no lower card to establish).

IT DEPENDS



- Intermediate length under the honor.
- Unclear dummy holding.
- Consider score, risk, and overall contract.